

Yebom Choi

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EDUCATION

Sungkyunkwan University, Seoul, South Korea - M.S. in Interaction Science GPA: 4.43/4.50 - Advisor: Changjun Lee - Thesis: <i>When AI Has a Body: Physical Embodiment, Mind Perception, and the Moralization of Agency</i>	Mar 2025 - Aug 2026
Sungkyunkwan University, Seoul, South Korea B.S. in Culture and Technology & Psychology GPA: 4.20/4.50	Mar 2021 - Feb 2025

RESEARCH INTEREST

Keywords: Human-AI interaction, mind perception and moral attribution in AI, proactive and creative AI

RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS

Master's-level Researcher (Appointed), AXIS Lab, Sungkyunkwan University	Sep 2026 - Feb 2027
Research Member, AXIS Lab, Sungkyunkwan University	2024 - Aug 2026

PUBLICATIONS

POSTERS AND CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

- [p.1] **The Benevolence Paradox: When Do Humans Stop Exploiting AI?**
Yebom Choi.
Extended Abstracts of CHI 2025, Article 905, 1-6.
- [p.2] **When the AI Exploitation Disappears: Factors Shaping Humans' Reciprocal Cooperative Attitudes Toward AI.**
Yebom Choi and Changjun Lee.
Proceedings of HCI Korea 2025, 438-443.
- [p.3] **No Time to Say Goodbye: Emotional Loss Responses to Sudden Termination in Immersive AI Interactions.**
Gahui Kim*, **Yebom Choi***, Yoojeong Kim*, and Changjun Lee. *Equal contribution; co-first authors.
Extended Abstracts of CHI 2026, Article 486, 1-5.
- [p.4] **See, Sense, Spark: Profiling Granularity in Proactive AI for Creative Research Ideation.**
Gahui Kim*, **Yebom Choi***, and Changjun Lee. *Equal contribution; co-first authors.
SIGGRAPH Asia 2025 Posters, Article 12, 1-3.
- [p.5] **Phodong: A Phygital Platform for Parent-Child Co-Creation.**
Gahui Kim*, **Yebom Choi***, and Yoojeong Kim*. *Equal contribution; co-first authors.
Proceedings of HCI Korea 2026.

IN SUBMISSION

- [s.1] **On the Desk, Not on the Screen: Physical Co-Presence and Implicit Moral Attribution to AI.**
Yebom Choi (lead author).
Submitted to ACM/IEEE HRI 2027.
- [s.2] **Homophily in Voice-Based AI: Age and Regional Identity Cues in Emotional Support Interaction.**
Yebom Choi, Sooyeon Kim, Haeyoon Lee, Changjun Lee, Daeho Lee, and Doha Kim.
Submitted to Telematics and Informatics.
- [s.3] **When AI Cooperation Is Not Enough: Human Consequences, Incentives and Guilt in a Mutual Cooperation Game.**
Yebom Choi and Changjun Lee.
Submitted to The Information Society.
- [s.4] **Goodbyes Matter: Immersive Relational Offboarding for Reducing Loss When AI Companion Interactions End.**
Gahui Kim*, **Yebom Choi***, Yoojeong Kim*, and Changjun Lee. *Equal contribution; co-first authors.
Submitted to ACM CHI 2027.
- [s.5] **How Much Should Proactive AI Know About Its User? Profile Granularity in AI-Glasses Support for Research Ideation.**
Gahui Kim*, **Yebom Choi***, and Changjun Lee. *Equal contribution; co-first authors.
Submitted to ACM CHI 2027.

[s.6] Chatbots that Comfort: Informational Support Is Key for Worry Reduction.

Sooyun Kim, Yebom Choi, and Changjun Lee.

Submitted to Computers in Human Behavior.

[s.7] When Virtual Meets Celebrity: Exploring Dual Pathways and the Emergence of Salience in Hybrid Influencer Advertising.

Yunwoo Choi, Yebom Choi, Kangwoo Lee, and Changjun Lee.

Submitted to JCRS.

JOURNAL ARTICLE

[j.1] What Makes Audiences Pay More for Immersive Cinema? A Conjoint Analysis of ScreenX Preferences and Willingness-to-Pay.

Gahui Kim, Soo Y. Kim, Sanghoon Park, Seoyoung Park, Yebom Choi, and Changjun Lee.

Journal of Information & Communications Policy, 32(4), 1-45, 2025. [Article in Korean]

TALKS AND PRESENTATIONS

No Time to Say Goodbye - Poster, ACM CHI, Barcelona, Spain	2026
When the AI Exploitation Disappears - Poster, Korean Association for Cybercommunication, South Korea	2026
See, Sense, Spark - Poster, SIGGRAPH Asia, Hong Kong	2025
The Benevolence Paradox - Student Research Competition, ACM CHI, Yokohama, Japan	2025

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Samsung Electronics Research Project, Industry-academic collaboration	2024
• Took primary responsibility for designing experiments that evaluated multimodal interaction techniques for TV display experiences.	
National Health Insurance Service Research Project, Institutional collaboration	2022 - 2023
• Collected and analyzed large-scale news data through web crawling to map monthly and annual issue trends and public response patterns.	
Youth AI Safety Evaluation Benchmark Development, ETRI AI Safety Institute	Sep 2026 - Present
• Develops and validates a Korean-language benchmark for risks in adolescents' use of AI chatbots and companion AI.	
Proactive AI and Human Cognitive Mechanisms in Always-On AI Environments, National Research Foundation of Korea (NRF; funded by the Ministry of Science and ICT [MSIT])	Mar 2026 - Feb 2029
• Contributes to proactive creative-AI research and prompt-generation engineering; related work resulted in a patent application.	
Personalized Story Generation Tailored to Children's Developmental Stages, Seoul RISE	Apr 2026 - Feb 2027
• Contributes to ontology design, age-adaptive language, prototyping, and child-centered evaluation.	

AWARDS AND RECOGNITIONS

Excellence Award, HCI Korea 2026 Creative Award - Phodong	2026
Finalist, UNESCO Global Higher Education Competition - Nongming	2025
Finalist, ACM CHI 2025 Student Research Competition	2025

FELLOWSHIPS AND PROGRAMS

Sungkyunkwan University Full-Tuition Graduate Excellence Scholarship	2024 - 2026
U300 Government-Supported Student Entrepreneurship Program - Selected Team: Phodong	2026
GS Content Leader Scholarship Recipient	2026

PATENT

[1] AI Prompt Generation Method.

Gahui Kim, Yebom Choi, and Changjun Lee.

Patent application, Sungkyunkwan University Industry-Academic Cooperation Foundation, Feb 2026.

TEACHING AND EDUCATIONAL EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, Culture Data and Machine Learning, Sungkyunkwan University	Fall 2025
Graduate Mentor, Undergraduate Research Credit Program (URP), Sungkyunkwan University	Spring 2025
Teaching Assistant, Information Retrieval, Sungkyunkwan University	Spring 2026
Assistant Instructor, AI Content Creation Workshop, Hyundai FutureNet	2026
• Supported a 10-hour hands-on workshop in generative AI and content production.	
Instructor, Multicultural Children's AI Education Workshop, Jongno-gu, Seoul	2026
• Led a 10-hour workshop using Phodong for object recognition, storytelling, and creative AI activities.	
Private Tutor, English, Mathematics, Science, and Korean	2020 - Present

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Research Methods: Experimental design, survey design, factorial ANCOVA, OLS regression, moderation, mediation/SEM, and conjoint analysis.

Programming and Analysis: R, Python, lavaan, and reproducible statistical workflows.

Prototyping: Figma and Unreal Engine (working knowledge); generative AI and multimodal prototyping.

Languages: Korean (native); English (TOEFL preparation in progress).

CREATIVE PROJECTS

Stand-Up Inter-University Convergence Academic Festival, Co-organizer	2023
• Co-organized a four-university academic festival for approximately 100 students, coordinating partnerships, programming, faculty engagement, and evaluation.	
Missionary Film, Director / Producer	2025 - Present
• Producing an AI-assisted virtual film using Unreal Engine and MetaHuman.	
Missionary Theater Productions, Production Lead	2022 - 2023
• Led two productions from concept and writing through direction and staging.	
Phodong: A Phygital Platform for Parent-Child Co-Creation	2025 - Present
• Developing a funded object-recognition co-creation app, currently in beta testing ahead of release.	